

Promises and Pressure: What the Numbers Hide

承诺与压力：数字隐藏了什么

Theme: 友谊、家庭与人际关系 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The **reporter** arrived with a photographer, a **film** crew, a **documentary** camera, and a question the group could not answer: why does the same **failure** look different in every home? A **cyclist**, a **pianist**, and a **cartoonist** gave three different accounts of one afternoon in the clinic, and an **ancient** habit of counting only the first one won again.

The numbers were a **glass** wall: **transparent** and hard. A **user** of the service, a **client** of the council, a **debtor** on the fifth floor: each had a different **estimation** of the same wait. “The **constant** is care,” Maya said. “Everything else is a **bubble**.”

A **spokesman** for the council, an **interviewer** from the radio, and an **informant** who asked not to be named described the **playground** as a success. “A **brick**, a **diamond**, and a **jewel** are all hard,” Lin said. “Only one of them is the gift of a **ruler**.” The **emperor** of that sentence was, he admitted, a **fool**, and the answer he gave the **reporter** was a **stupid** one.

A photographer wrapped a **blanket** around a child who had been waiting since morning, and took a **photo** of the queue. A woman with a bandaged arm waited with a second **photo** in her hand. “Certainly you have room for one more,” she said, and the camera turned toward her. “That is a **laugh** and a **sigh** in one gesture,” the **assistant** said. “Our **transparency** is **childish**,” the **designer** replied, “and the **offender** is the system, not the **blanket**.” A **contestant** in the queue agreed, and asked for a second **blanket**.

The **recipient** of the service, a **prisoner** on day release, a **buyer** of the cheapest plan, and an **adventurer** who had walked the whole route: none of them had been asked for a single line. “A **messenger** is not a **liar**,” the **spokesperson** said, “but a **messenger** is not a witness either.” The group had its highest increase in trust that week, and its lowest in love. A patient would have said it better; a friend would have said it more kindly. The mean version was this: that the subject of the survey had never been the people in it.

中文翻译

记者带着一名摄影师、一个摄制组，以及一个小组答不上来的问题到来：为什么同一次失败在每个家庭里看起来都不一样？一位骑车人、一位钢琴家和一位漫画家，对诊所里同一个下午给出了三种不同说法；而只统计第一个说法的那种古老习惯又一次赢了。

数字是一堵玻璃墙：透明而坚硬。服务的使用者、议会的客户、五楼的债务人：每个人对同一次等待都有不同的估计。“恒量是照料，”曼雅说，“其他一切都是泡沫。”

议会的一位发言人、电台的一位采访者，以及一位要求匿名的线人，把那个运动场说成一次成功。“砖块、钻石和珠宝都很硬，”林伟说，“但其中只有一件是统治者的礼物。”他承认，写出这句话的皇帝是个傻瓜，而他给记者的回答是个愚蠢的回答。

一位摄影师把一条毯子裹在一个从早上就开始等待的孩子身上，并拍下了队伍的照片。一位手臂缠着绷带的女士在等待，手里拿着第二张照片。“你当然还有位置再加一个，”她说，镜头转向了她。“那是一个手势里的笑声与叹息，”助理说。“我们的透明很幼稚，”设计师回答，“有罪的是这个系统，不是这条毯子。”队伍里一位参赛者表示同意，并要了第二条毯子。

服务的接受者、一位白天获释的囚犯、最便宜方案的购买者，以及一位走完全程的冒险者：他们当中没有一个人被问过一句话。“信使不是说谎者，”那位发言人说，“但信使也不是证人。”那一周小组在信任上增幅最高，在爱上却是最低。一位病人会说得更更好，一位朋友会说得更温和。刻薄的版本是这样的：调查的主题从来不是其中的人。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
film film POS: n	n. 软片, 薄膜, 胶卷, 电影; vt. 覆以薄膜, 拍摄; vi. 生薄膜, 拍电影 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a medium that disseminates moving pictures; n. photographic material consisting of a base of celluloid cove...
user 'ju:zə POS: n	n. 使用者; [计] 用户 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who makes use of a thing; someone who uses or employs something
glass glɑ:s POS: n	n. 玻璃, 玻璃杯, 透镜; vt. 装玻璃于, 反射, 反映; vi. 成玻璃状 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a brittle transparent solid with irregular atomic structure; n. a container for holding liquids while drink...
laugh lɑ:f POS: n	n. 笑, 笑声; vi. 笑, 大笑; vt. 以笑表示 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the sound of laughing; n. a facial expression characteristic of a person laughing; v. produce laughter
client 'klaɪənt POS: n	n. 客户, 顾客, 委托人; [计] 客户, 客户机, 客户机程序 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who seeks the advice of a lawyer
failure 'feɪljə POS: n	n. 失败, 失败者, 不足, 缺乏, 破产; [计] 故障, 失效 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an act that fails; n. an event that does not accomplish its intended purpose; n. lack of success; n. a person...
reporter rɪ'pɔ:tə POS: n	n. 记者, 报告者; [化] 指示器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who investigates and reports or edits news stories
photo 'fəʊtəʊ POS: n	n. 相片, 照片, 逼真的描绘; v. 照相; a. 照相的, 摄影用的, 详细记录的, 逼真的, 酷似的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a representation of a person or scene in the form of a print or transparent slide; recorded by a camera on...
ancient 'eɪnfənt POS: a	a. 古代的, 古老的, 年老的, 旧的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a very old person; n. a person who lived in ancient times; s. belonging to times long past especially of the...
constant 'kɒnstənt POS: n	n. 常数, 恒量; a. 不变的, 一定的, 时常的; [计] 常量; 常数; 恒值 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a quantity that does not vary; n. a number representing a quantity assumed to have a fixed value in a speci...
prisoner 'prɪznə POS: n	n. 囚犯, 犯人, 战俘; [法] 犯人, 囚犯, 扣押犯 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who is confined; especially a prisoner of war
buyer 'baɪə POS: n	n. 买主, 买方; [经] 买主, 买方, 买手 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who buys
wrap ræp POS: n	n. 外套, 围巾, 包裹物, 限制, 约束, 秘密, 换行; vt. 包装, 卷, 缠绕, 包, 裹, 覆盖, 遮蔽, 隐藏, 掩护; vi... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. cloak that is folded or wrapped around a person; n. a sandwich in which the filling is rolled up in a soft...
spokesman 'spəʊksmən POS: n	n. 发言人, 代言者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a male spokesperson
designer dɪ'zaɪnə POS: n	n. 设计者, 谋划者, 制图者; [计] 设计员 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who devises plots or intrigues
stupid 'stju:pid POS: a	a. 愚蠢的, 麻木的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who is not very bright; a. lacking or marked by lack of intellectual acuity
assistant ə'sɪstənt POS: n	n. 助手, 助理, 助教; a. 有帮助的, 辅助的, 助理的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who contributes to the fulfillment of a need or furtherance of an effort or purpose
brick brɪk POS: n	n. 砖块, 积木; a. 用砖做的; vt. 用砖造, 用砖砌 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. rectangular block of clay baked by the sun or in a kiln; used as a building or paving material; n. a good f...
sigh saɪ POS: n	n. 叹息; vi. 叹息, 渴望; vt. 叹息着说 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an utterance made by exhaling audibly; n. a sound like a person sighing; v. heave or utter a sigh; breathe d...
emperor 'empərə POS: n	n. 皇帝, 君主 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the male ruler of an empire; n. red table grape of California; n. large moth of temperate forests of Eurasia...
blanket 'blæŋkɪt POS: n	n. 毛毯, 毯子; vt. 掩盖, 覆盖; a. 总共的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. bedding that keeps a person warm in bed; n. anything that covers; n. a layer of lead surrounding the highly...
fool fu:l POS: n	n. 愚人, 受骗者, 奶油拌水果; vt. 愚弄, 欺骗, 浪费; vi. 干傻事, 开玩笑, 游荡; a. 傻的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who lacks good judgment; v. make a fool or dupe of

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
offender ə'fendə POS: n	n. 罪犯, 无礼的人, 得罪人的人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who transgresses moral or civil law
recipient rɪ'sɪpiənt POS: a	a. 领受的, 容易接受的, 感受性强的; n. 领受者, 容纳者, 容器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who receives something
diamond 'daɪəmənd POS: n	n. 钻石, 菱形; [计] 菱形 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a transparent piece of diamond that has been cut and polished and is valued as a precious gem; n. very hard...
bubble 'bʌbl POS: n	n. 泡沫; vi. 冒泡, 沸腾; vt. 使冒泡, 滔滔不绝地说 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a hollow globule of gas (e.g., air or carbon dioxide); n. an impracticable and illusory idea; n. a dome-shap...
ruler 'ru:lə POS: n	n. 统治者, 管理者, 尺, 直尺; n. 划线板; [计] 标尺 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who rules or commands
documentary 'dɒkjʊ'mentəri POS: n	n. 纪录片; a. 文件的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a film or TV program presenting the facts about a person or event; a. relating to or consisting of or deriv...
debtor 'detə POS: n	n. 债务人, 借主, 借方; [法] 负债者, 债务人, 借方 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who owes a creditor; someone who has the obligation of paying a debt
playground 'pleɪgraʊnd POS: n	n. 运动场, 操场, 度假胜地, 活动场所 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. yard consisting of an outdoor area for children's play
transparent træns'pærənt POS: a	a. 透明的, 显然的, 清晰的; [计] 透明 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. easily understood or seen through (because of a lack of subtlety)
jewel 'dʒu:əl POS: n	n. 珠宝, 贵重物, 镶珠宝的饰物; vt. 饰以珠宝, 镶以宝石 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a precious or semiprecious stone incorporated into a piece of jewelry; n. a person who is as brilliant and...
messenger 'mesɪndʒə POS: n	n. 报信者, 使者; [经] 使者, 送信者, 通信员 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who carries a message
interviewer 'ɪntəvjʊ:ə POS: n	n. 会见者, 面谈者, 进行面试者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who conducts an interview
liar 'laɪə POS: n	n. 说谎者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who has lied or who lies repeatedly
cyclist 'saɪklɪst POS: n	n. 骑脚踏车的人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who rides a bicycle
informant ɪn'fɔ:mənt POS: n	n. 提供消息者, 密告者, 被调查者; [经] 填报人, 被征询人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who supplies information
pianist 'piənɪst POS: n	n. 钢琴家, 钢琴演奏者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who plays the piano
adventurer əd'ventʃərə POS: n	n. 冒险家, 投机者; [法] 冒险者, 投机者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who enjoys taking risks
transparency træns'pærənsɪ POS: n	n. 透明, 透明度, 透过性, 透明物, 清晰; [计] 透明性; 透明 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. permitting the free passage of electromagnetic radiation; n. the quality of being clear and transparent
childish 'tʃaɪldɪʃ POS: a	a. 天真的, 孩子气的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. indicating a lack of maturity
contestant kən'testənt POS: n	n. 竞争者; [法] 争辩者, 竞争者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who participates in competitions
spokesperson 'spəʊkspɜ:sn POS: n	n. 发言人, 代言人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an advocate who represents someone else's policy or purpose
estimation 'estɪ'meɪʃən POS: n	n. 判断, 估计, 尊重; [化] 估计; 估定; 测定; 估值 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a document appraising the value of something (as for insurance or taxation); n. the respect with which a pers...
cartoonist kɑ:'tu:nɪst POS: n	n. 漫画家 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who draws cartoons